illuminated for the first time the normative questions related to cyber warfare. The main question that arose was: What is the right balance between a state's security needs and individual freedoms, in particular freedom of speech? Although there were rumors that the National Security Agency (NSA), which deals with electronic intelligence, had been secretly accessing the databases of Google, Yahoo, and others, it was only on October 30, 2013, that real evidence was produced. The immediate response of the organizations that had been penetrated by the NSA was to encrypt all of the data flowing between the company's data centers. The companies' spokespeople also issued unequivocal denials, maintaining that they had not cooperated with the government. These revelations showed that cyber infiltration concerns not only national security and diplomacy but also the economy, especially when it comes to financial data about internet technologies.

The European Union and most of its member states reacted immediately by announcing their intention to reexamine their cooperation with the United States on these issues, in light of the disclosure that the United States was giving priority to its intelligence agencies, which they believed created an unfair advantage for American bodies competing with European bodies. The American internet industry, which usually cooperates to some extent with the administration when it comes to national security, was astonished at the extent of NSA infiltration into friendly countries as well as hostile countries. Internet financial companies (databases for use in advertising) have also begun to use encryption. Notably, NSA operations in the United States are subject to far more legal and regulatory restrictions than those outside of the United States.

Some voices in the United States suggest that the Snowden affair was an intelligence operation carried out by either Russia or China, or by a joint operation between the two. There is quite a bit of circumstantial evidence to support this theory (Snowden fled from the United States to Hong Kong and from there went on to Russia, where he obtained political asylum that was extended in January 2017 for another two years). A book published in the United States in early 2017 suggested that the moral dilemma Snowden supposedly found himself in was simply a cover story for his actions. And there you have another interesting aspect of the cyber world.

Normative Dilemmas Created by Cyber Warfare